



Brand Voice + Website Copy System

Website language, product drops, community suggestions, outreach and marketing standards

Working brief for madebutter. in Ridgway, Colorado

part bakery. part product lab.

Logo note: the madebutter. mark is actively improving. The current icon, wordmark and butter-yellow period should be treated as the working brand system while the logo continues to tighten.

1. Purpose of This Brief

This document defines how madebutter. sounds across the website, menu, packaging, order ahead, suggestions, community drops, staff messaging and local outreach.

madebutter. should feel simple at the counter and precise behind the counter. The customer sees warm food, clear prices, useful details and a menu that changes in a thoughtful way. Staff use the same language to keep products, drops, suggestions and marketing tied back to one system.

This is not a final legal, nutrition or allergen document. It is the copy system that helps the brand stay consistent while the product lab evolves.

Core idea

A clean bakery product lab in Ridgway, Colorado making small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee with a daily menu built around consistency, freshness and controlled experiments.

The website should never feel like a generic donut catalog. It should feel like a daily drop board for products that are tested, photographed, finished fresh and worth coming back for.

2. Brand Foundation

The foundation is short enough to repeat on packaging, menus, the website and staff training.

madebutter. is built around a few recognizable product forms. The shapes stay consistent. The flavors, fillings, glazes and drops create the range.

The public brand should be warm, clean and food-forward. The operating system underneath can feel scientific, but the customer does not need to see every production detail. They should feel the result: clear photos, clear descriptions, repeatable products and fresh items ready when they order.

Positioning	part bakery. part product lab.
Location	Ridgway, Colorado.
Core products	Small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee.
Personality	Warm, minimal, curious, consistent and a little playful.
Customer promise	The product should look like the photo as closely as possible, taste fresh and feel easy to order.
Internal promise	Every item has a family, spec, photo reference, packaging format and quality target.

Use the phrase "product lab" carefully. It should suggest care, testing and repeatability. It should not make the food sound cold or over-engineered.

3. Voice Principles

The voice should be quiet, confident and useful. It should never over-explain the brand.

Principle	What it means	Example
Simple	Use short sentences and plain words.	Fresh today. Order ahead or come on in.
Warm	Make the food feel cared for without sounding sentimental.	Made small, finished clean and ready when it is ready.
Precise	Every product should sound defined.	A milk ring with banana cream glaze and a soft vanilla finish.
Playful	Let the brand smile without becoming childish.	Send us a flavor idea. If it works, it might become a drop.
Product-focused	Talk about shape, glaze, filling, texture and freshness.	Half-dipped cruller with a light shell and chocolate glaze.
Local	Mention Ridgway when it adds warmth or context.	Small batch donuts and stuffed rolls in Ridgway, Colorado.

The brand should feel like a clean Japanese bakery influence filtered through a Colorado product lab. Clear photos. Exact names. Simple descriptions. Tight systems.

4. Copy Rules

These rules keep the brand voice consistent across the website, packaging, notifications and social posts.

Brand name	Use madebutter. lowercase with the period. The period is part of the mark.
Punctuation	Avoid em dashes. Avoid Oxford commas. Keep sentences clean.
Tone	No fake luxury. No heavy hype. No corporate food language.
Length	Customer copy should be short. Staff notes can be detailed.
Product names	Use consistent family names so people learn the system.
Descriptions	Say what it is, what it is made with and why it matters.
Buttons	Use active language like order ahead, suggest a flavor, see today's menu and join the drop list.
Logo note	The current logo is in progress. Use the newest mark but leave room for future refinement.

Preferred copy rhythm: short title, then one useful paragraph. For product cards, use one clean sentence. For drop posts, use one hook, one product detail and one call to action.

5. Core Phrase Bank

Approved short phrases for pages, packaging, footers, cards and captions.

Brand anchors	part bakery. part product lab. fresh today made in Ridgway, Colorado worth coming back for
Ordering	order ahead or come on in ready soon fresh now today's menu is live
Drops	today's drop limited batch test batch community drop back if it sells
Suggestions	send us a flavor idea tell us what to make next good ideas can become drops
Quality	made to match the photo small batch, finished clean consistent shape, new flavors
Product lab	tested in small batches built from a simple base refined until it repeats

Avoid using too many brand phrases at once. The website can repeat a few anchor lines, but product pages should stay useful and specific.

6. Website Page Copy System

The website should feel like a live daily menu with a clean brand story around it.

The current site structure supports a hero slideshow, about section, full dynamic menu, sticky category rail, cart, checkout, confirmation page and admin system. This copy system gives each page a role so the developer can keep future pages consistent.

Page	Role	Copy direction
Home	Create immediate appetite and explain the concept.	Hero slides, about copy, daily menu language and order ahead cues.
Menu	Help customers choose quickly.	Category intros, short product cards, sold out and low stock states.
Order Ahead	Make checkout feel easy.	Clear steps, no tax confusion and simple pickup language.
Suggestions	Invite the community into the lab.	Open, friendly and low pressure. No account required if possible.
Community Drops	Show the loop from idea to test to drop.	Celebrate suggestions and repeat winners.
About	Tell the story without overdoing it.	Title plus one flowing paragraph. Keep it clean.
Contact	Make it easy to reach the shop.	Plain language for questions, events and suggestions.
Footer	Quietly reinforce the brand.	Short blurb, signup, links and back of house access.

7. Home Page Copy

The homepage should sell the feeling first, then make the menu easy to enter.

The home page should lead with food, freshness and the daily menu. The copy should sit around the product photography without fighting it. Keep lines short enough to work on mobile.

Hero slide set

Slide	Headline	Supporting line
1	fresh today	Small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee in Ridgway, Colorado.
2	order ahead or come on in	Pick what looks good now. We will keep it simple when it is ready.
3	send us a flavor idea	The best suggestions can become limited drops, test batches and future menu favorites.

About section option

part bakery. part product lab.

madebutter. makes small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee in Ridgway, Colorado. We keep the shapes consistent, test new flavors in small batches and build each day around what is fresh, ready and worth coming back for. Order ahead or come on in.

Menu intro option

Today's menu changes with the rack. Some items are daily staples. Some are limited drops. If something sells out, it did its job.

8. About Page Copy

The about page should feel like a title and one clean paragraph, not a long brand essay.

Recommended title

part bakery. part product lab.

Recommended paragraph

madebutter. is a small bakery product lab in Ridgway, Colorado built around donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee. We care about simple forms, clean packaging, accurate photos and products that stay consistent from batch to batch. The menu can change, but the standard stays tight. Some flavors become daily staples. Some start as suggestions, turn into limited drops and come back when people ask for them. Order ahead or come on in.

Short version for footer or packaging

Small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee. Fresh today in Ridgway, Colorado.

More playful version

We make the same shapes again and again so the flavors can keep moving. Some ideas come from us. Some come from you. The good ones get tested, dropped and maybe kept.

9. Menu Copy System

Product copy should teach the customer the family first, then explain the flavor.

Every menu item should have a name, short description, ingredient line, allergen language when ready, price and availability state. The customer should know what they are buying without reading a paragraph.

Family	Category intro	Description pattern
Milk Donuts	Soft raised rings finished with clean milk-style glazes.	Raised milk ring with [flavor] glaze and a soft [finish].
Mochi Rings	Airy mochi-style rings with a light pull-apart shape.	Airy mochi ring with [glaze] and [accent].
Old Fashioneds	Craggy butter old fashioned with glossy glaze in the ridges.	Butter old-fashioned with [glaze] and a crisp ridge finish.
Cream Donuts	Filled donuts built around smooth cream centers.	Filled milk donut with [cream] and [finish].
Milk Bars	Long milk bars with full top dips and restrained drizzle.	Long milk bar with [glaze], [drizzle] and a soft raised base.
Half-Dipped Crullers	Light French crullers with one clean dipped side.	French cruller half dipped in [glaze].
Market Fritters	Hand-formed fritters using fruit, pantry glazes and seasonal ideas.	Market fritter with [fruit or pantry item] and [glaze].
Croissant Kolaches	Flaky croissant-style kolaches built for morning grab-and-go.	Croissant kolache with [filling], baked fresh in the morning.
Stuffed Rolls	Soft house rolls filled with fully cooked savory inserts.	Stuffed roll with [filling], baked fresh and built for lunch.

10. Product Description Examples

Simple descriptions that mix the Mister Donut style with madebutter. detail.

The goal is brief, useful and flavorful. Mention glaze, filling or finish. Do not over-explain the recipe on the card.

Product	Customer description	Optional detail line
banana cream milk ring	Raised milk ring with banana cream glaze and a soft vanilla finish.	Contains milk, wheat and egg.
matcha milk ring	Raised milk ring with matcha milk glaze and a clean green tea finish.	Bright, smooth and not too sweet.
black sesame honey old-fashioned	Craggy old-fashioned with black sesame glaze and honey finish.	Nutty, glossy and bakery-rich.
half-dipped chocolate cruller	Light French cruller with one clean chocolate-dipped side.	Designed to keep the shell visible.
maple brown butter milk bar	Long milk bar with maple brown butter glaze and cream drizzle.	Soft raised bar with a rich top dip.
market fritter	Hand-formed fritter with market fruit and glossy vanilla glaze.	The fruit changes with the batch.
all-beef sausage croissant kolache	Flaky croissant-style kolache with all-beef sausage.	Baked fresh for morning grab-and-go.
jalapeno cheddar all-beef kolache	Croissant kolache with all-beef sausage, cheddar and two jalapeno slices.	Savory, flaky and cleanly portioned.
brisket cheddar pepper stuffed roll	Soft stuffed roll with smoked brisket, cheddar and pepper filling.	Built from fully cooked filling molds and baked fresh.

11. Suggestions System

Suggestions should feel fun, open and very easy to submit.

The suggestion form is one of the strongest community pieces. It lets customers send flavor ideas, product ideas, filling ideas and seasonal requests. It should be anonymous-friendly and not feel like homework.

Suggestion page headline
tell us what to make next

Page paragraph option

Got a donut flavor, kolache idea, stuffed roll filling or coffee pairing we should test? Send it in. We read the ideas, tag the ones that fit and turn the best ones into small batch drops. If your idea works and people love it, we may owe you something sweet.

Field	Label	Helper copy
Idea	What should we make?	Donut flavor, kolache filling, stuffed roll idea or anything close.
Category	Where does it fit?	Donut, kolache, stuffed roll, coffee or surprise us.
Details	Tell us the good part	Flavor, texture, filling, glaze, wood smoke, topping or inspiration.
Name	Want credit?	Optional. Leave it blank if you want.
Contact	Want to hear back?	Optional. We may reach out if your idea becomes a drop.

Confirmation copy

Got it. We added your idea to the lab board. If it turns into a drop, we hope you come try it.

12. Community Drops

Community drops turn suggestions into a repeatable brand loop.

A community drop should feel like a small release, not a random special. The idea can come from a customer, staff member, local season, ingredient test or production experiment. The website should make that loop visible without making it complicated.

Step 1	A customer suggests a flavor, filling or product idea.
Step 2	Staff tags the idea by product family, ingredient, season and difficulty.
Step 3	The kitchen tests a small batch and photographs the approved version.
Step 4	The item launches as a limited drop with a fixed quantity.
Step 5	The item either retires, returns for another drop or becomes a regular menu item.

Community drop copy examples

Use case	Headline	Line
Suggestion winner	you asked. we tested.	This flavor came from the suggestion board and made it through the lab.
Limited item	small batch today	Available until it sells out. If it moves, we may bring it back.
Return item	back from the board	A community favorite is back on today's menu.
New test	test batch live	A small run to see if this one belongs.
Feedback ask	should it stay?	Try it today and tell us if it should come back.

13. Outreach + Marketing System

Marketing should feel like drops, rewards and local invitations. Keep it fun and direct.

madebutter. marketing should not sound like a chain promotion. It should feel like a small product company releasing food people can actually pick up. The main channels are the website, Instagram, email, SMS, local outreach and in-shop signage.

Channel	Purpose	Voice
Instagram	Show the food and packaging.	Photo first. One clean line. One useful detail.
SMS	Fast drop alerts and ready notifications.	Short, useful and only when it matters.
Email	Launch notes, rewards and community drops.	Still brief, but can tell the story.
Local outreach	Invite neighbors, offices, hotels and shops.	Friendly and specific to Ridgway.
In-shop signage	Explain what is fresh now.	Simple labels, clear pricing and soft product lab language.
Website	The source of truth.	Dynamic menu, product detail and order ahead.

Outreach ideas

Hotels and stays	Small cards that say order ahead or come on in, with today's menu QR and a short Ridgway note.
Local businesses	Morning tray drop preview, staff rewards or limited office preorders.
Community ideas	Monthly suggestion winner, tasting window or first batch alert.
Travelers	Travel-ready packaging, clean sleeves and easy order ahead before leaving town.
Rewards	Thank people for trying drops, submitting ideas and coming back.

14. Rewards + Drop Language

Rewards should feel special without becoming a complicated points program at launch.

Keep early rewards simple. Use them to create excitement around product drops, suggestion winners, return visits and local support.

Moment	Copy	CTA
New drop	Today's drop is live. Small batch, clean finish, gone when it is gone.	Order ahead
Reward	You came back. We noticed. Your next treat is on the board.	Claim reward
Suggestion selected	Your idea made it into testing. Come try the first batch.	See the drop
Sold out	That one moved fast. Join the drop list and we will tell you when it returns.	Join the list
Local invite	Fresh batch is ready in Ridgway. Come in or order ahead.	See today's menu
Return drop	Back because people asked. Limited today.	Order ahead

Use "limited" only when the quantity is actually limited. Use "drop" when the item is new, returning or suggestion-driven. Use "fresh today" for the daily menu.

15. Notification Copy

Notifications should be helpful first and branded second.

Order messages should never be cute at the expense of clarity. Customers need to know what happened, when to pick up and what to do next.

Message	SMS copy	Email subject
Order received	madebutter. got your order. We will let you know when it is ready.	we got your order
Ready for pickup	Your madebutter. order is ready. Come in and grab it when you can.	your order is ready
Pickup reminder	Your order is still waiting at madebutter. Come by when you can.	pickup reminder
Drop live	Today's drop is live at madebutter. Small batch and ready now.	today's drop is live
Suggestion selected	Your suggestion made it to testing. Watch for the drop.	your idea made the board
Sold out return	That one sold out. We will tell you if it comes back.	sold out for today

Confirmation page copy

Your order is in. We will send a message when it is ready. Keep your receipt number handy when you come in.

16. Social Media Voice

Social should be visual, clean and quick to read.

Social captions should not explain the whole business. Let the photo do most of the work. The caption gives a product name, drop status and simple action.

Post type	Caption pattern	Example
Daily menu	Fresh today: [items]. Order ahead or come on in.	Fresh today: banana cream rings, all-beef kolaches and market fritters.
Drop	[Product] is on the board today. Limited batch.	Black sesame honey old-fashioned is on the board today. Limited batch.
Suggestion	This one came from the suggestion board.	You suggested matcha milk with a little salt. We tested it.
Behind the scenes	Show process without overexplaining.	Same shape. New glaze. First batch is cooling.
Sold out	Let it feel positive.	That batch is gone. Good sign. We may bring it back.
Reward	Make it feel personal.	Come back this week and check the board. Something sweet is waiting.

Avoid too many exclamation points. Avoid fake scarcity. Avoid sounding like a national chain.

17. Staff-Facing Voice Rules

Staff should have simple ways to explain the brand, products and daily menu.

Staff language should be friendly and operational. The goal is to help customers understand what madebutter. is without turning every interaction into a pitch.

What is madebutter.?	We are part bakery, part product lab. We make small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee.
Why does the menu change?	We have staples, then we test limited drops and seasonal flavors.
Can I suggest something?	Yes. Send it through the suggestion form. Good ideas can turn into drops.
Why is something sold out?	We make set batches so the product stays fresh and controlled.
What is a community drop?	It is a limited item that started as a suggestion or small test.
Are products consistent?	That is the goal. We use photo references, specs and repeatable processes so each item matches what we show.

Staff should not promise a suggestion will be made. The safer line is "good ideas can become drops."

18. Website Microcopy + States

Small interface language matters because the menu is dynamic.

State	Customer-facing copy	Design note
Available	add	Bright item card with normal image.
Low stock	only [number] left	Show when six or fewer are ready.
Sold out	sold out	Dim item and remove add action.
Not today	not today	Keep visible only when useful for the menu story.
Cart empty	Nothing in the box yet.	Friendly but not silly.
Checkout step 1	How should we reach you?	Contact first.
Checkout step 2	Review and pay.	Payment second.
Payment success	You are on the board.	Then show order number.
Pickup	We will message you when it is ready.	Launch language before scheduled slots.

Customer-facing inventory should stay simple. The staff side can track prep, rack counts and future production stages. Guests only need to know what is ready or nearly gone.

19. What Not To Say

This section protects the brand from drifting into the wrong tone.

Avoid	Overly fancy artisan language that makes the food feel precious.
Avoid	Generic donut shop language like best donuts in town or sweet dreams.
Avoid	Scientific language that makes the customer imagine lab food.
Avoid	Huge paragraphs on the home page or menu cards.
Avoid	Copy that promises every suggestion becomes a product.
Avoid	Discount-heavy language that trains people to wait for deals.
Avoid	Anything that sounds copied from Mister Donut instead of inspired by its clarity.

Better direction: calm confidence, clear product detail and a small smile. The butter icon can be playful. The copy should stay steady.

20. Reusable Copy Bank

Approved blocks that can be copied into the site, footer, menu or launch notes.

Short brand blurb

madebutter. is a bakery product lab in Ridgway, Colorado making small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee. The menu changes, the standards stay tight and the best ideas can become limited drops.

Footer blurb

Small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee. Fresh today in Ridgway, Colorado.

Suggestion blurb

Tell us what to make next. Send a donut flavor, kolache filling, stuffed roll idea or anything close. Good ideas can become limited drops.

Drop blurb

Today's drop is a small batch test from the madebutter. lab. If it sells, it may come back.

Order ahead blurb

Order ahead or come on in. We will keep the menu current and let you know when your order is ready.

21. Current Website Copy Draft

A ready-to-use copy pass for the current site structure.

Hero slide 1

fresh today

Small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee in Ridgway, Colorado.

Hero slide 2

order ahead or come on in

Pick what looks good now. We will message you when your order is ready.

Hero slide 3

send us a flavor idea

Suggestions help shape limited drops, test batches and future menu favorites.

About module

part bakery. part product lab.

madebutter. makes small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee in Ridgway, Colorado. We keep the shapes consistent, test new flavors in small batches and build each day around what is fresh, ready and worth coming back for.

Footer

Small batch donuts, croissant kolaches, stuffed rolls and coffee. Fresh today in Ridgway, Colorado.

22. Next Briefs Connected To This

These briefs should use the same voice rules and website copy standards.

Packaging + Retail System Brief	Sleeves, boxes, labels, future retail, shelf language and packaging copy hierarchy.
POS + Order Ahead + Pickup System Brief	Guest checkout, staff POS, pay screen, kiosk, ready notifications and pickup operations.
Product Specs + Menu Description Brief	Product names, descriptions, ingredients, allergens, staff prep notes and batch size logic.
Suggestion Loop Admin Brief	Suggestion intake, tagging, testing, drop approval, customer credit and archive rules.
Launch Marketing Brief	Opening campaign, email and SMS signup, local outreach, hotel cards, social cadence and reward rollout.

The brand voice brief should stay alive. As the logo improves, the website launches, products are tested and the suggestion loop becomes real, this document should be updated to match the working system.

End of brief.